

The Art of Cartography

Mapping the World — From Ancient Charts to Digital Frontiers

Ancient Origins

How early civilizations first captured the shape of the world on clay, papyrus, and parchment.

01

The Ptolemaic Tradition

Claudius Ptolemy's *Geographia* established the mathematical framework for projecting a sphere onto a flat surface. Written in the 2nd century, it remained the Western world's definitive reference for over a thousand years.

His system of latitude and longitude coordinates, though imprecise by modern standards, laid the conceptual groundwork for every map that followed.



The Age of Exploration

When mariners charted coastlines and currents across
uncharted seas





Modern Techniques

From aerial photography to satellite imagery — the tools that transformed how we see the Earth.

02

Cartography in Numbers

The scale and precision of modern mapping have grown exponentially, driven by satellite technology and geographic information systems.

Known Projections

200+

Satellite Imagery Resolution

30cm

Global GIS Market Size

\$14.5B

The Portolan Charts

Medieval portolan charts were navigational maps characterized by networks of rhumb lines radiating from compass roses. Their remarkable accuracy of Mediterranean coastlines astounded scholars for centuries.



*“A map does not just chart,
it unlocks and formulates
meaning.”*

Maps are more than navigational tools. They encode worldviews, power structures, and cultural assumptions. Every projection is a choice — and every choice reveals what the cartographer values most.

Artistic Cartography

Hand-drawn maps remain prized for their beauty and unique perspective. Contemporary artists continue the tradition of illustrated cartography, blending scientific accuracy with aesthetic vision.

From medieval *mappae mundi* to modern data visualizations, the map remains one of humanity's most powerful storytelling devices.





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Thank you

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